by negotiations. [16] India failed to recognize the deception and swallowed the Chinese bait again. India's Mission in Lhasa and the political officer in Gangtok were asked to discreetly convey to the Tibetans that the Dalai Lama should not be encouraged to seek asylum in India. [17]

The other concern of China, of external interference, centered on Nepal. Zhou Enlai probed Panikkar more than once whether the King (Tribhuvan), who had ousted the pro-British Ranas from power (with India's assistance), was susceptible to British or American influence, and might provide them with a staging ground to interfere in Tibet. This was a deep concern for China at the time. Chinese leader Liu Shaoqi confirmed this in his conversation with Soviet Ambassador Roshchin in May 1951, when he told him that Chinese plans to insert the PLA into Tibet would be complicated if Nepal interfered in the Tibetan question. [18] Nepal had historically invaded Tibet in previous centuries and this was, therefore, a matter of genuine concern for the Chinese. India was again quick to provide reassurance to the Chinese on this count. China's tactics in keeping India engaged over Tibet in 1951 without raising the points of contention, bought vital time and space for the Chinese to conclude the 17-Point Agreement between the Central Government of China and the Local Government of Tibet on Measures for the Peaceful Liberation of Tibet on 23 May 1951. With India having dissuaded the Dalai Lama from coming to India, he also eventually accepted the 17-Point Agreement on 24 October 1951. Thus, by the end of 1951, the Chinese had achieved the second phase of their strategy, namely to secure a legal basis for the People's Republic of China's claim over Tibet, and ended the possibility of united Tibetan opposition to Chinese rule.

India's strategy and tactics after the invasion in October–November 1950 was revealed by the Prime Minister in his note